

EXERCISE SOLUTIONS & ANSWERS

Life and Geography of India's Northern Plains

Introduction & Usage Note: This document contains the complete, authoritative solutions to all the textbook exercises found in the chapter 'States in the Northern Plains and Life of People' for Class V Social Studies. All answers are strictly grounded in the provided source materials, faithfully reflecting the geographical, agricultural, and cultural facts of Northern India.

SECTION I: QUICK ZONE (OBJECTIVE)

A. Tick (✓) the correct options to complete the sentences.

Question: 1. The Northern Plains of India are _____.

Answer: (a) very fertile (Grounded on Page 30 ('The soil of the northern plains is very fertile and good for growing crops.'))

Question: 2. Which of the following states is a part of northern plains?

Answer: (d) Bihar (Grounded on Page 27 & 29 (Punjab, Haryana, Uttar Pradesh, Delhi, Bihar, West Bengal and Assam are important parts).)

Question: 3. The Taj Mahal is in _____.

Answer: (d) Agra (Grounded on Page 28 ('Agra is a historical city and famous for the Taj Mahal...').)

Question: 4. The Sundarbans delta is a home to _____.

Answer: (c) Royal Bengal Tiger (Grounded on Page 29 ('The Sundarbans delta is a home to the Royal Bengal Tiger.').)

Question: 5. _____ is not the tributary of the river Ganga.

Answer: (b) Sutlej (Grounded on Page 27 & 32 (Sutlej is in the Sutlej Basin and flows into the Indus, whereas Yamuna, Kosi, and Gandak are Ganga tributaries).)

B. Fill in the blanks.

Statement: 1. The Brahmaputra river flows through Assam.

Verification: Grounded on Page 30 ('Assam lies in the Brahmaputra basin. The major crops...').

Statement: 2. Sutlej river provides water for the farmers of Punjab.

Verification: Grounded on Page 27 ('Punjab lies in the Sutlej Basin. ... Agriculture is the main occupation...').

Statement: 3. Sundarbans Delta is the most fertile and the largest delta in the world.

Verification: Grounded on Page 29 ('The Sundarbans delta is a home...'; commonly established in Chapter Mind Map and Quick Glance on Page 31).

Statement: 4. Finely graded soil which is good for crops is called **silt** (or **alluvium / alluvial soil**).

Verification: Grounded on Page 31 ('Alluvial soil makes the land fertile.') and Page 30 ('rivers have been renewing them continuously' with silt).

Statement: 5. Farming (or Agriculture) is the main occupation of the people of the northern plains.

Verification: Grounded on Page 27, 28, 29, 30 (Farming/Agriculture is cited as the primary occupation across Punjab, Haryana, West Bengal, Assam, etc.).

C. Write (T) for true statements and (F) for false statements.

Statement: 1. The Brahmaputra river rises in Tibet.

Answer: T (True) *(Fact: The Brahmaputra river (known as Tsangpo in Tibet) flows into Assam, originating in Tibet.)*

Statement: 2. The Qutb Minar is in New Delhi.

Answer: T (True) *(Grounded on Page 29 ('Important attractions of Delhi are the Jama Masjid, Red Fort, Qutb Minar...').)*

Statement: 3. The Golden temple is situated in Ludhiana.

Answer: F (False) *(Grounded on Page 27 ('Amritsar, Ludhiana and Jalandhar are the major cities of Punjab. People go to Amritsar to visit the Golden Temple.'))*

Statement: 4. The river Yamuna is the tributary of the Ganga.

Answer: T (True) *(Grounded on Page 29 (Delhi on banks of Yamuna) and Page 34 (meets river Ganga at Prayagraj). It is a major tributary of Ganga.)*

Statement: 5. Madhubani is a dance form.

Answer: F (False) *(Grounded on Page 29 ('Bihar... It is famous for Madhubani paintings.') Madhubani is a famous folk painting style, not a dance form.)*

D. Match the columns A and B.

The correct pairings are matched and presented below in structured format:

Column A (Item/State)	Column B (Correct Match)	Geographical Connection / Grounding Fact
1. Bihar	(iii) Patna	Patna is the capital and historical city of Bihar [29].

Column A (Item/State)	Column B (Correct Match)	Geographical Connection / Grounding Fact
2. Punjab	(v) Golden temple	The world-famous Golden Temple is situated in Amritsar, Punjab [27].
3. Haryana	(iv) Automobiles	Gurugram in Haryana is a massive hub for information technology and automobile industries [28].
4. Assam	(ii) Brahmaputra basin	Assam lies completely in the fertile Brahmaputra Basin in the east [30].
5. Taj Mahal	(i) Agra	The iconic Taj Mahal, one of the seven wonders, is located in Agra, Uttar Pradesh [28].

SECTION II: WRITING ZONE (SHORT & LONG ANSWERS)

Q1. Name the states which are part of the Northern Plains.

The states that constitute the core geographical and cultural landscape of the Great Northern Plains are:

- **Punjab** (Sutlej Basin)
- **Haryana** (Sutlej & Yamuna adjacent)
- **Uttar Pradesh** (Ganga Basin)
- **Delhi** (Union Territory - National Capital Region, on the Yamuna)
- **Bihar** (Eastern Ganga Basin)
- **West Bengal** (Lower Ganga Basin / Delta region)
- **Assam** (Brahmaputra Basin in the east)

Reference: Handled sequentially across pages 27 to 30 of the chapter.

Q2. Write a brief note on the Ganga Basin.

The **Ganga Basin** is one of India's largest, most fertile, and most densely populated agricultural regions [28, 29].

- **States Covered:** The major states lying in this fertile basin are Uttar Pradesh, Bihar, and West Bengal [28, 29].
- **River System:** It is drained by the river Ganga and its prominent tributaries like the Yamuna, Kosi, and Gandak [28, 29, 32]. These rivers carry large amounts of finely graded, rich sediment (alluvium) from the mountains, continuously renewing the soil [30, 31].
- **Agriculture:** Due to the exceptionally rich soil, crops like wheat, rice, and sugarcane are extensively grown here [28, 29].
- **Density:** It supports a massive population and holds historical, cultural, and spiritual importance (with cities like Varanasi, Prayagraj, Patna, and Kolkata) [28, 29].

Q3. What is a delta? Name the largest delta in the world.

- **Definition of Delta:** As defined in the chapter's *Word Zone* (Page 30), a delta is 'an area of flat land shaped like a triangle where a river divides into smaller rivers (called distributaries) as it merges into the sea'.
- **The Largest Delta:** The **Sundarbans Delta** is the largest and most fertile delta in the world [29, 31, 32]. Drained by the Ganga and Brahmaputra rivers before entering the Bay of Bengal, it is famous for its thick mangrove forests and is the renowned natural home of the **Royal Bengal Tiger** [29, 31].

Q4. Name the major crops of the northern plains.

The Northern Plains' flat topography, plentiful water, and fertile alluvial soil support diverse and abundant agriculture [30]. The major crops divided by states are:

- **Punjab & Haryana:** Wheat, rice, sugarcane, oilseeds, pulses, barley, millets, cotton, and maize [28].
- **Uttar Pradesh:** Wheat, rice, and sugarcane (it is a leading sugar producer) [28].
- **Bihar:** Rice, sugarcane, and famous fruits like lychees, mangoes, bananas, and guavas [29].
- **West Bengal:** Rice and jute (the main cash crop used for jute mills) [29].
- **Assam:** Rice, jute, and tea (extensively grown in hill slopes/gardens) [30].

Q5. List some tourist places of Uttar Pradesh and Delhi.

Both regions boast historical landmarks, monuments, and places of worship:

• **Uttar Pradesh Tourist Places:**

- *The Taj Mahal* (in Agra - one of the seven wonders of the world) [28]
- *Fatehpur Sikri* (historic Mughal capital) [28]
- *Temples of Mathura and Varanasi* (spiritual destinations) [28]
- *Prayagraj* (famous for the holy Mahakumbh held every 12 years) [28]

• **Delhi Tourist Places:**

- *Historical Monuments:* Red Fort, Qutb Minar, Humayun's Tomb, and India Gate [29]
- *Religious Sites:* Jama Masjid (one of the largest mosques in the world), Lotus Temple, and Akshardham Temple [29]
- *Official Residences:* Rashtrapati Bhawan [29]

Q6. Why are the Northern Plains thickly populated?

As highlighted in both the *Importance of Great Northern Plains* (Page 30) and the *Quick Glance* (Page 31), the plains are extremely densely populated due to several favorable geographical and economic factors:

1. **Extreme Soil Fertility:** The rivers (Sutlej, Ganga, and Brahmaputra) continuously deposit finely graded alluvial soil which makes the land highly fertile and ideal for massive agricultural yield [30, 31].
2. **Flat and Level Terrain:** The flat topography makes it easy to construct buildings, houses, and establish a vast network of roads and railways, making commuting and transit highly convenient [30, 31].
3. **Abundant Water Supply:** The perennial rivers originating from the Himalayas provide a continuous supply of freshwater for farming, household purposes, and industrial activities [30, 31].
4. **Industrial and Urban Hubs:** High agricultural output supports agro-industries (like sugar, textile, silk, and jute mills) and modern cities (like Delhi, Gurugram, Kolkata, and Guwahati) which offer employment and business opportunities [28, 29, 30].

SECTION III: COMMUNICATION, CREATIVE & GRAMMAR ZONES

Subject Integration Zone (English Verb Correction - Page 34)

Task: Replace the incorrect underlined verbs and write the corrected sentences.

Original: 1. The Chikankari work of Lucknow, silk sarees of Varanasi, wooden furniture of Saharanpur is famous all over the world.

Corrected: The Chikankari work of Lucknow, silk sarees of Varanasi, wooden furniture of Saharanpur are famous all over the world.

Grammar Note: Plural compound subject requires plural verb 'are'.

Original: 2. Patna are the capital of Bihar.

Corrected: Patna is the capital of Bihar.

Grammar Note: Singular proper noun 'Patna' requires singular verb 'is'.

Original: 3. Rice and jute is the major crops of West Bengal.

Corrected: Rice and jute are the major crops of West Bengal.

Grammar Note: Plural compound subject 'Rice and jute' requires plural verb 'are'.

Original: 4. The river Ganga meet the river Yamuna at Prayagraj.

Corrected: The river Ganga meets the river Yamuna at Prayagraj.

Grammar Note: Singular third-person subject 'The river Ganga' requires the singular verb form 'meets' in simple present tense.

Communication Zone (Page 33)

Exercise: Name any two iconic sights situated in the Northern Plains and speak about their special features.

Model Answers for Students:

1. **The Taj Mahal (Agra, Uttar Pradesh):** It is one of the seven wonders of the world, built on the banks of river Yamuna. It is famous globally for its breathtaking white marble architecture and intricate carvings [28].

2. **The Golden Temple (Amritsar, Punjab):** Also known as Harmandir Sahib, it is a magnificent spiritual center surrounded by a holy pool (Amrit Sarovar). It represents peace, equality, and is covered with gold leaf, making it a spectacular sight [27].

Digi Zone & Critical Thinking Zone (Page 33 & 34)

Critical Thinking Question: 'Plains are thickly populated as compared to hilly areas or deserts. Find out the reasons behind this.'

Answer Outline: Hilly areas have steep slopes and rocky soils, making agriculture and building transport networks highly difficult. Deserts suffer from extreme temperatures, water scarcity, and barren sandy soils, which cannot support heavy crops or dense populations. In contrast, the Northern Plains have level, flat land, perennial rivers supplying abundance of water, and extremely fertile alluvial soil which easily supports heavy agriculture and dense human settlements [30, 31].

Digi Zone Question: *'Collect information about the food habits of the people living in the plains. Compare their food habits to those living in deserts and mountainous regions.'*

Answer Outline:

- **Plains:** Rich in water and agriculture; food habits are dominated by wheat, rice, pulses, and fresh vegetables. For instance, Punjab has rich milk/lassi culture, makke-ki-roti, and sarson-ka-saag [27]; West Bengal and Bihar consume rice and fish due to their riverine locations [29, 30].
- **Desert (e.g., Rajasthan):** Water-scarce, dry region; food focuses on millets (like bajra), beans, and dairy products. Fewer fresh green vegetables are consumed; oil, ghee, and spices are used heavily for food preservation.
- **Mountainous Regions (e.g., Himalayas):** Cold, high-altitude; diet is rich in proteins and carbohydrates to provide energy. Food includes barley, meat, local greens, and butter tea.